

Extremely short focal lengths can distort the perspective of a scene, and long ones tend to flatten it.

5.3.3 Clipping planes

Clipping planes define the distances over which the camera will work. This is toggled on by using the Clip Manually option. Clipping planes can, however, be used for various tasks, such as dividing a scene into layers for rendering. You might also want to adjust a clipping plane manually when you are modelling. For example, you might need to work on part of a model in wireframe without being distracted by all the vertices on the back side of the model. By setting the clipping plane close to the working plane, you can hide the far side of the model.

5.3.4 Depth of field

Depth of field simulates how a real-world camera focuses. Focus is important in cameras because it allows the photographer to guide the viewer's eye to the important parts of the scene. Cameras tend to focus objects in a range of distances. A low depth of field means the range is narrow; fewer parts of the scene will be in focus. Conversely, the higher the depth of field, the more of the scene will be in focus.

3ds Max has several ways to create depth of field, depending on the renderer used. The scanline renderer has Depth of Field as a multi-pass effect or as a rendering effect. Mental ray has its own tools available in the Render Scene dialog box.

The multi-pass Depth of Field effect is created by toggling on the effect in the camera's Parameters rollout. The actual parameters for the effect are located in the Depth of Field Parameters rollout. Multi-pass effects are created by rendering the scene in several passes and then averaging the



Camera targeting cylinder



Camera targeting sphere